Connecting WhatsApp to Eddie

A complete click-by-click guide. Follow it in order, on a laptop, with your Instagram or Facebook password ready.

What you are doing and why

You are connecting your own WhatsApp number to Meta's official business system, then giving Eddie the keys so it can answer customers without you. Nothing here costs money at the test stage.

At the end you will hold three things:

1. Phone number ID (a long number Meta assigns to your WhatsApp number)
2. Permanent access token (a secret password for your app)
3. Your WhatsApp number (the one customers message)

Keep the token private. Treat it like your bank PIN.

Part 1: Create your Meta developer account

1. Open https://developers.facebook.com in Chrome on a laptop.
2. Click "Get started" in the top right. If you see "My Apps" instead, you already have an account and can skip to Part 2.
3. A login page appears. Log in with the Facebook account you want the business attached to. Do not create a new Facebook account just for this.
4. Confirm your email if Meta asks.
5. Choose "Developer" when it asks what describes you, then click Next.
6. Click "Create first app" or "Go to dashboard".

Part 2: Create the app

1. On the dashboard, click "Create app".
2. App name: type "Eddie" (or your business name). It must not contain "WhatsApp" or "Meta".
3. App contact email: your email.
4. Click Next.
5. Use case screen: choose "Other", then Next.
6. App type screen: choose "Business", then Next.
7. On the "Select a business portfolio" screen, pick your business if you have one. If you have none, leave it empty and click Next.
8. Review the summary and click "Create app". Enter your password if asked.
9. You land on the App Dashboard for Eddie. Bookmark this page.

Part 3: Add WhatsApp and read the API Setup screen

1. On the dashboard, scroll to "Add products to your app".
2. Find "WhatsApp" and click "Set up".
3. Accept the terms and click Continue.

4. You are now on WhatsApp > API Setup. This screen holds almost everything we need.

5. Read it carefully, top to bottom:

- "WhatsApp Business Account ID" sits at the top. Copy it into your notes.

- "From" shows the free test number Meta gave you, for example +1 555 123 4567. Messages you send come from this number during testing.

- "Phone number ID" is written under the From number, or in the dropdown beside it. Copy it. This is number one of the three things I need.

- "To" is a field where you add your own WhatsApp number so Meta allows messages to it.

- "Access token" with a "Generate" or "Copy" button. This is the temporary token, valid about 24 hours. Copy it for the test only. We replace it with a permanent one in Part 5.

6. Click "Manage phone numbers" or the dropdown near From to see the Phone number ID if you cannot find it.

Part 4: Send your first real test message

1. In the "To" field, select your country code, then type your own WhatsApp number without the leading zero. Example: 2348023123838.

2. Click "Add phone number" or "Send" beside the field.

3. Meta now sends a verification code to that WhatsApp. Open WhatsApp, copy the code, paste it back into Meta.

4. Scroll to "Send a message" on the same screen.

5. Leave the template as "hello_world".

6. Click "Send message".

7. Check your WhatsApp. A message arrives from the Meta test number saying "Hello World".

That message proves the whole chain works. Nothing else matters until you see it.

Part 5: Create the permanent token

The token from Part 4 dies in 24 hours. This is how you get one that lasts.

1. Open https://business.facebook.com/settings in a new tab.

2. In the left menu, click "Users", then "System users".

3. Click "Add". Name it "eddie-bot". Role: Admin. Click "Create system user".

4. With eddie-bot selected, click "Add assets".

5. Choose "Apps", tick your Eddie app, enable "Full control", then "Save changes".

6. Still on eddie-bot, click "Generate new token".

7. Select your Eddie app.

8. Tick these two permissions: whatsapp_business_messaging and whatsapp_business_management.

9. Click "Generate token".

10. Copy the token immediately. Meta shows it once and never again. Paste it somewhere safe for one minute, then we move it into Eddie.

Part 6: Where all three numbers go

1. Open https://eddie-wa.vercel.app and set up or edit your assistant.

2. Scroll to the box marked "Advanced - connect a real AI model", or ask me for the WhatsApp connection box if it is not yet on your screen. Send me the three values and I will place them properly with the token stored as a secret, not in the page.

3. If you prefer to do it yourself, paste them into the fields in this order: Phone number ID, token, your WhatsApp number.

4. Save. Reload the page. The setup must survive a reload.

5. Send a test from the app. If it arrives, Eddie is connected.

Part 7: Going from test to real customers

The test number is not yours. To answer customers on your own number you need three more steps.

1. In WhatsApp > API Setup, click "Add phone number". Use a number that is not currently on WhatsApp, or delete that number from the WhatsApp app first.

2. Verify it with the code Meta sends by SMS or call.

3. Set a display name, for example "Eddie Stores". Meta reviews it, usually within a day.

4. Open https://business.facebook.com/settings, go to "Business info", then "Business verification", and submit your CAC document if you have one. Verification raises your messaging limits.

5. Optional but needed for full auto-replies: ask me to set the webhook. That is a URL I give you to paste into WhatsApp > Configuration, plus a verify token we agree on.

Part 8: What happens to your messages and money

1. Messages you send to customers who wrote to you first, inside 24 hours, are free.

2. Messages you start yourself, like a price broadcast, are charged per message and the rate depends on the country. Check Meta's WhatsApp pricing page before sending campaigns.

3. Your customers' chats live in Meta's system, not on my server. Eddie's own setup stays on your device.

4. Never paste your token into a group chat, a screenshot, or a public repo. If it leaks, come back to the System User page and click "Revoke".

Part 9: When something goes wrong

1. Error 190 or "Invalid OAuth access token": your token expired or was copied with a space. Generate a new one in Part 5.

2. Error 131030 "Recipient phone number not in allowed list": while in test mode, only numbers you added in the To field can receive messages. Add the number first.

3. Error 100 or "Unsupported get request": the Phone number ID is wrong. Copy it again from API Setup, not from the URL.

4. Message never arrives: check you used a number with country code and no plus sign, and confirm the test message from Part 4 worked.

5. "App not verified" banners: normal at this stage. Verification matters when you go live.

Part 10: Your checklist

Tick these off in order:

1. Meta developer account created

2. App named Eddie created, type Business
3. WhatsApp product added, API Setup open
4. Test message "hello_world" received on your WhatsApp
5. System user created with a permanent token
6. Phone number ID, token and number sent to me
7. Connection tested from inside Eddie
8. Real number added and verified
9. Business verification submitted
10. Webhook set, so replies send by themselves

Built for EdIdiong Orok. Eddie is the WhatsApp assistant product: https://eddie-wa.vercel.app